

Murder Mystery

Dinner Party 2026



Anne E. Dote

The Meridian Museum

October 30, 2026 / Private player packet / 1 of 12

INTRODUCTIONS



Anne E. Dote

Director of Education & Docent Programs

Anne can make a school group care about a pot shard. Tonight's donors are proving harder.

- Coaches **Reed DeLabel** through gallery tours. **Reed** keeps adding footnotes to the children's handouts.
- Turns **Claire O'Scuro**'s research into tours people can follow. **Claire** keeps restoring the difficult words.
- Invites **Justin Tyme** to speak about Tulsa history. She now reviews his slides before inviting donors.

ACTING TIPS

Engaging, practical, empathetic, irreverent about institutional pomp.

YOUR INTRODUCTION / READ THE BOX ALOUD

I'm Anne E. Dote. I run education here. I can make almost anything interesting, including a room full of adults behaving badly.

Continue to your private briefing on page 3. Keep the packet facing you.



Anne E. Dote

Behind the portrait

Your grievance with Grant

Grant's gift conditions would cut public education programming to fund a private donor lounge and VIP entrance.

Your other secret

You organized an anonymous staff petition against the plan and slipped copies into trustee folders.

Conversations to start

- Ask Anya Tique whether she will defend the education program against a donor lounge.
- Ask Claire O'Scuro what ordinary visitors would lose if education funding disappeared.

If a named guest is absent, speak to someone else. Your printed account may conceal another scandal, even if you are innocent. Stick to it during the hearings; save corrections for Coming Clean.

Memorize your animal and return the slip. When the host announces the selected animal, use IF MURDERER if it matches yours; otherwise use IF INNOCENT. Never read an IF heading aloud.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Anne E. Dote

The museum has misplaced its paperwork. Naturally.

Sixteen numbered envelopes are hidden around the house. These three hints lead to three different hiding places. Leave the furniture and household objects where they are. Bring an envelope to the Evidence Table; read and share the discovery inside.

- 1 *The artwork is innocent; something behind it deserves questioning.*
- 2 *A Bible contains a small addition that is not part of scripture.*
- 3 *The mirror has a secret that never appears in its reflection. Look above the glass.*

Already found? Read that discovery at the Evidence Table, then try another hint. Ask for help reaching a hiding place; nobody needs to climb. You may investigate together.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Anne E. Dote

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 6, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did Grant's financial plans threaten to take from you?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What did Grant pressure you to approve or overlook?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did Grant demand over a sale or purchase?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

How did Grant threaten your work or reputation?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What unwelcome research did Grant want suppressed?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did Grant ask you to hide, and why?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute demand put your work at risk?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What dispute made you want Grant's announcement stopped?

Any Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What past decision was Grant threatening to expose?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

How did Grant's decisions threaten your livelihood or work?

Your speaking box is on page 6. Turn only within this act.



Anne E. Dote

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I organized the anonymous petition against Grant's education cuts. He wanted a donor lounge where the children's budget used to be. From 6:39 to 6:45 I was live with a school group and Henri the hippo. Henri asked why the museum needed a private entrance. I had written that question. The children deserved an answer.

IF MURDERER

The anonymous petition was mine. Grant's donor lounge would cost school tours and community programmes their budget. I sent an earlier Henri the hippo segment to the school group and kept distributing trustee folders. A puppet was apparently allowed to ask the question adults had been instructed to avoid.

You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**

ACT II: OPPORTUNITY



Anne E. Dote

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 8, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

Where were you before the toast, and why?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What were you checking in the exhibition, and when?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What occupied you before Grant's private toast?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

Where did your work take you before the toast?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What were you examining before the unveiling, and when?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

What did you observe while the toast was prepared?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What last-minute work were you doing, and where?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

Where did you go before the toast, and why?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What drew you to the exhibition before the toast?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What were you arranging before Grant drank?

Your speaking box is on page 8. Turn only within this act.

ACT II: OPPORTUNITY



Anne E. Dote

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you. After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I took the school-tour proposal to Grant early and then went to the outreach desk. After the session I sorted trustee folders at the gallery entrance. The petition was underneath the donor conditions in every copy. I wanted somebody voting on those conditions to meet the children they were cutting out.

IF MURDERER

I was sorting trustee folders near the gallery entrance before the toast. Henri's segment was with the school moderator already. I had taken my proposal to Grant early and kept an extra petition in my bag. He was going to announce the cuts as an improvement to the visitor experience. I wanted the visitors described accurately.

You can ask someone to repeat a detail. Discuss your suspicions after everyone has answered.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
Wait for the host to announce the next round.**



Anne E. Dote

Questions for the room

Choose a named guest who has not answered. Skip absent names. Ask their question; they answer from page 10, then choose the next guest. The host tracks turns.

Artie Ficial / Monet Bags / Tess Tament

What did you handle or conceal during setup?

Claire O'Scuro / Chip Patina / Sue Venir

What materials or records passed through your hands?

Hugh Bidder / Elon Mosaic / Saul D. Bid

What did you borrow, conceal or change tonight?

Dada DiCapo / Vincent Van Faux / Drew Conclusions

What did you alter that could look suspicious?

Dr. Art E. Fact / Reed DeLabel / Justin Tyme

What did you discover or conceal in your work?

Barb Dwyer / Paige Turner / Faye Stop

Which objects or records need your explanation?

Frank Lloyd Wrong / Al Baster / Minnie Malist

What changed during setup, and what did you do?

Mona Lott / Elle Loominate / Robin Banks

What might someone misinterpret about your preparations?

Anya Tique / Ella Gance / Penny Pincher

What part of your past or preparation needs explaining?

Brie DeVivre / Cary Crates / Anne E. Dote

What passed through your hands that matters tonight?

Your speaking box is on page 10. Turn only within this act.



Anne E. Dote

Your answer

Read only the bordered words when asked. Keep your packet facing you.
After answering, ask an unheard guest their question from the previous page.

IF INNOCENT

I slipped the petition into trustee folders without approval. Henri's question about the private door was deliberate too. The children did not know it was a budget dispute. They understood that some people were being offered a better door than others. Grant asked me to remove the question from the recording. I left it in.

IF MURDERER

I put the petition in trustee folders and left Henri's question in the school segment after Grant asked me to remove it. The proposal and an extra petition went to his salon earlier. I wanted the trustees to explain the cuts to an audience capable of asking why. Grant intended a much more agreeable discussion of his generosity.

The sixteen discoveries and five reports remain at the Evidence Table.



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Anne E. Dote

Your ballot

Choose one attending guest. Explain your accusation in your own words. Fold this loose page writing inward and give only the ballot to the host. Keep your packet for Coming Clean. Votes lock when all ballots are collected.

Your character name

I accuse

Why? Motive, evidence and any unresolved contradiction

Best Actor

Best Costume



**STOP! Do not turn the page yet.
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Anne E. Dote

The last word

Read only when the host calls you. Top three suspects read first. If none confesses, the host calls the selected animal to stand. Use your own role's box; keep every other word private.

IF INNOCENT / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

I ran the anonymous petition and wrote the puppet's question. The school's retained live feed shows me with Henri for the full contamination interval. I intended to protect the tours by forcing a public discussion. Grant's death does not restore a budget. The trustees will still have to answer that question, and I did not poison him.

IF MURDERER / READ ALOUD WHEN CALLED

The school group saw an earlier segment. I used the sleeve cloth to carry stolen toxin and wipe Grant's coupe before returning to the folders. He intended to cut the tours and call it improvement. I decided to remove him instead of persuading the trustees. Henri's question was mine; so was the murder.

Every selected suspect gets their final word.